

MacroLens Daily Brief — September 14, 2026

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Top Headlines

1. Counting the votes: Warsh faces a tough battle as the Fed girds for expected interest rate hike

CNBC — 2026-09-14 18:50

Fed Chair Warsh faces a divided FOMC as markets price a 92% probability of a quarter-point hike to 3.50%-3.75%, with over 75% odds of another move in December; August inflation and fuel prices rose, though Goldman Sachs attributes the overshoot to one-time tariff and Iran war energy factors.

2. AI stocks tumble on safety warnings. How to proceed — including 2 names on our shopping list

CNBC — 2026-09-14 12:59

AI stocks sold off Monday on safety warnings, with Jim Cramer outlining how to navigate the decline and naming two stocks on the Investing Club's shopping list.

3. Asia's oil traders, seeing no quick end to Middle East war, stay bullish on prices - Reuters

Reuters — 2026-09-14 10:46

Asian oil traders remain bullish on prices, expecting no quick end to the Middle East war, according to Reuters.

4. Morning Bid: Shipping oil gets ever harder, costlier - Reuters

Reuters — 2026-09-14 04:33

Oil shipping is becoming increasingly difficult and costly amid Middle East disruptions, Reuters reports.

5. COMMENTARY: Oil markets survived the Iran war sprint. Now comes the marathon - Reuters

Reuters — 2026-09-14 00:01

Oil markets absorbed the initial shock of the Iran war but now face a prolonged period of disruption, per Reuters commentary.

6. Not all tech is under fire in Monday's selling, while investors seek refuge in defensive stocks

CNBC — 2026-09-14 19:27

Monday's tech sell-off was not uniform, with some tech names holding up while investors rotated into defensive stocks.

7. US imposes fresh sanctions on Russia's VTB Bank over alleged Iran ties - Reuters

Reuters — 2026-09-14 21:12

The US imposed fresh sanctions on Russia's VTB Bank over alleged ties to Iran.

8. AirBaltic files for Chapter 11 bankruptcy as Iran war costs bite - Reuters

Reuters — 2026-09-14 06:47

AirBaltic filed for Chapter 11 bankruptcy, citing costs tied to the Iran war.

9. Iran protests as US prevents its nuclear chief attending IAEA meeting - Reuters

Reuters — 2026-09-14 11:49

Iran protested after the US blocked its nuclear chief from attending an IAEA meeting.

10. As the oil surge continues, trader Mike Khouw sees more upside in this surging name

CNBC — 2026-09-14 17:16

Oil's surge is driving broader market direction, with trader Mike Khouw seeing more upside in a surging energy name; ECB's Lagarde and BoE's Bailey highlighted policymakers' new focus on refining margins and crack spreads as geopolitical disruptions tighten supply.



Market Snapshot

Ticker	Name	Price	1D Return	Signal
US Equities				
SPY	S&P 500 ETF	764.29	+0.85%	 bullish
QQQ	Nasdaq 100 ETF	714.88	+0.87%	 bullish
DIA	Dow Jones ETF	525.79	+0.97%	 bullish
IWM	Russell 2000 ETF	288.89	+0.41%	 neutral
XLK	Technology ETF	187.67	+1.32%	 bullish
XLF	Financials ETF	57.25	+0.67%	 bullish
US Treasuries				
SHY	2Y Treasury ETF	81.37	-0.06%	 neutral
IEF	10Y Treasury ETF	91.01	-0.19%	 neutral

Ticker	Name	Price	1D Return	Signal
TLT	20Y+ Treasury ETF	80.87	+0.11%	 neutral
Credit				
LQD	Investment Grade Bond ETF	104.32	-0.04%	 neutral
HYG	High Yield Bond ETF	78.60	-0.03%	 neutral
Commodities				
GLD	Gold ETF	398.77	+0.61%	 bullish
SLV	Silver ETF	58.12	+1.08%	 bullish
USO 	Oil ETF	154.90	-2.20%	 bearish
UNG	Natural Gas ETF	10.17	-0.20%	 neutral
FX				
UUP	US Dollar Index ETF	28.07	+0.14%	 neutral
FXE	Euro ETF	107.01	-0.11%	 neutral
FXJ	Japanese Yen ETF	59.68	+0.47%	 neutral
Crypto				
BTC-USD	Bitcoin	76838.16	-0.56%	 bearish
ETH-USD	Ethereum	2477.02	-1.94%	 bearish

Key Macro Indicators

Indicator	Value	As Of
Fed Funds Rate Target	3.5% – 3.75%	2026-09-14
10Y Breakeven Inflation (%)	2.37	2026-09-14
10Y-2Y Yield Spread (bp)	0.32	2026-09-14
VIX	15.84	2026-09-11
USD Index (Broad)	118.2126	2026-09-11

Major Anomalies

USO — Oil ETF -2.20%

Cause: Oil prices fell as fresh US sanctions on Russia's VTB Bank over alleged Iran ties raised concerns about global demand and financial market stability, while the launch of Africa's largest refinery by Dangote signaled potential long-term supply increases.

Forward Impact: USO may remain under pressure if demand worries persist and new refinery capacity adds to global supply, though geopolitical tensions could provide support.

Macro Data Releases — Today

[Calendar error: 403 Client Error: Forbidden for url: https://finnhub.io/api/v1/calendar/economic?from=2026-09-14&to=2026-09-22&token=d88f5hpr01qq4342ton0d88f5hpr01qq4342tong]

Economic Calendar — Next 7 Days

No upcoming macro events in the next 7 days.

Sector Heat Map

Sector Performance Heatmap			
	1D	5D	1M
Energy	+0.3%	+0.8%	+6.7%
Communication Services	+1.0%	-0.7%	+2.1%
Technology	+1.3%	+0.9%	-0.6%
Financials	+0.7%	-2.2%	-1.2%
Healthcare	-0.2%	-4.6%	-1.8%
Consumer Staples	+0.3%	-2.2%	-2.0%
Real Estate	+0.9%	-1.9%	-2.4%
Materials	+0.4%	-3.2%	-3.1%
Utilities	-0.3%	-1.5%	-3.3%
Consumer Discretionary	+0.9%	-3.0%	-4.2%
Industrials	+1.1%	-1.2%	-7.3%

Hot Now

- **Energy (XLE)** — Energy leads with positive returns across all three timeframes and the strongest 1-month gain (+6.7%), signaling sustained momentum.
- **Technology (XLK)** — Technology shows the best 1-day move (+1.3%) and positive 5-day momentum (+0.9%), with only a shallow 1-month dip (-0.6%) suggesting recent strength.
- **Communication Services (XLC)** — Communication Services has the second-best 1-day gain (+1.0%) and positive 1-month return (+2.1%), indicating resilient demand despite a modest 5-day pullback.

Cold but Worth Watching

- **Industrials (XLI)** — Industrials is the worst 1-month performer (-7.3%) but posted a solid 1-day bounce (+1.1%), hinting at early mean-reversion interest.
- **Consumer Discretionary (XLY)** — Consumer Discretionary is down 4.2% over 1 month yet rose 0.9% on the day, suggesting oversold conditions may attract buyers.
- **Materials (XLB)** — Materials has fallen 3.1% over 1 month but edged up 0.4% today, a potential stabilization signal after a 3.2% 5-day decline.

A defensive-to-cyclical rotation is underway, with energy and tech leading while beaten-down industrials and consumer discretionary show tentative signs of bottoming.



Daily Conclusion

Energy leads a tech-supported rally as markets brace for a Fed rate hike under Warsh.

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